

How common is it?

Last revised in December 2024

- **Diabetes is one of the most common chronic diseases in the UK, and the prevalence is increasing** [NICE, 2019b ([/topics/diabetes-type-1/references/](#))].
 - Diabetes UK estimates that in the UK [Diabetes UK, 2019 ([/topics/diabetes-type-1/references/](#))]:
 - About 4.7 million people have diabetes.
 - About 36,000 children under 19 years of age have diabetes (most children are diagnosed between the ages of 10 and 14 years).
 - More than 5 million people will be diagnosed with diabetes by 2025, and more than 5.5 million by 2030.
- **Type 1 diabetes most commonly presents in children and young people, persists into and can start in adult life** [NICE, 2015a ([/topics/diabetes-type-1/references/](#))].
 - It can present at any age, although incidence peaks in early childhood (age 6 months to 5 years) and again during puberty [NICE, 2015a ([/topics/diabetes-type-1/references/](#))].
 - About 8% of people with diabetes have type 1 diabetes [Diabetes UK, 2019 ([/topics/diabetes-type-1/references/](#))], and the prevalence is highest in people aged 35–60 years of age [NICE, 2015a ([/topics/diabetes-type-1/references/](#))].
 - About 90% of children and young people in the UK who have diabetes will have type 1 diabetes [Diabetes UK, 2019 ([/topics/diabetes-type-1/references/](#))].

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